

You Li (Leo)

402 W Dayton St, Madison, WI, 53703
608-707-2182 | yli2544@wisc.edu | [LinkedIn](#) | [Github](#) | [Personal Site](#)

EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Bachelor's of Science, Computer Science

- GPA: 3.89

Madison, WI

Expected Graduation: December 2026

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI Research Intern

University of Wisconsin-Madison, Department of Computer Sciences

Madison, WI

September 2023 – Present

- Engineered a Python data pipeline to curate high-quality human debate samples for training LLM agents to simulate opinions across demographic groups, enabling research on AI agents as proxies for human participants
- Fine-tuned and evaluated LLMs using Supervised Fine-Tuning (SFT) and Direct Preference Optimization (DPO), achieving 78% embedding-based semantic similarity with human responses
- Parallelized LLM simulation pipelines using Python multiprocessing, reducing experiment runtime from 3 days to 12 hours (6× speedup)

Software Engineer Intern

Intelligible AI

Madison, WI

May 2026 – August 2026

- Enhanced semantic search for 500+ users using Cohere Embed v4, Cohere Rerank 3.5 models, and Amazon OpenSearch Serverless vector search, improving search recall (Recall@20) by 57% and ranking quality (NDCG@10) by 47%
- Built a search evaluation benchmark and automated test harness using Python, Docker, and GitHub Actions, evaluating 500 relevance queries (MRR@10: 0.99) and verifying zero unauthorized results across 1,015 access-control tests
- Architected an automated dataset provisioning workflow using Next.js, AWS Lambda, and DynamoDB, streamlining onboarding for 3 enterprise clients representing \$720,000 in ARR

Software Engineer Intern

MDAQ-Global

Singapore

September 2024 – February 2025

- Developed REST APIs with Django and PostgreSQL for an internal software lifecycle management platform, reducing manual engineering effort through workflow automation
- Created document and image uploads using AWS S3 and Terraform, reducing manual artifact handling for DevOps and infrastructure teams
- Migrated automation workflows to asynchronous background processing using Celery and AWS SQS, eliminating ~7-second blocking waits and making user interactions effectively instantaneous

AI Engineer Intern

KLASS Engineering and Solutions

Singapore

May 2023 – August 2023

- Trained and evaluated EfficientPS, YOSO, and Mask2Former using PyTorch and NumPy for scene recognition on autonomous patrol robots
- Containerized and deployed computer vision models to Jueying X20 robots using Docker, enabling autonomous city-street deployment projected to save \$300K annually in labor costs

AI Research Intern

Agency for Science, Technology and Research (A*STAR)

Singapore

January 2022 – September 2022

- Designed and implemented a full-stack experimental platform using JavaScript, Flask, and SQLite that supported psychological studies with 500+ participants
- Trained and evaluated ResNet18, VGG16, AlexNet, and Vision Transformer models across novel-object and image-transformation datasets

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Chuang, Y.; Tu, R.*; Dai, C.*; Li Y.*; Vasani, S; Yao, B; Tessler, M; Yang, S; Shah, D; Hawkins, R; Hu, J;
*Authors with core contributions
“DEBATE: A Large-Scale Benchmark for Evaluating Opinion Dynamics in Role-Playing LLM Agents.”, Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2026. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.25110>
- Singh, P.; Li, Y.; Sikarwar, A.; Lei, W.; Gao, D.; Talbot, M.B.; Sun, Y.; Shou, M.Z.; Kreiman, G.; Zhang, M.; “Learning to Learn: How to Continuously Teach Humans and Machines”, International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV) 2023. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2211.15470>

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, SQL

Frameworks: Next.js, React, Django, FastAPI, PyTorch

Databases & Cloud: PostgreSQL, AWS (Lambda, S3, SQS, DynamoDB, OpenSearch), Docker, Terraform